

Malhar Gudekar

(217) -766-0681 — gudekar2@illinois.edu — LinkedIn — Portfolio — GitHub

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

August 2024 - May 2026

Master of Science, Information Management

GPA: 3.8/4

• Coursework: Web Programming, Machine Learning & Cloud, Information Management, Information Consulting, Methods of Data Science

University of Mumbai

June 2019 - May 2023

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science

GPA: 9.25/10

• Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Object-Oriented Programming, Machine Learning, NLP

SKILLS

• **Languages & DSA:** Python, SQL, Data Structures & Algorithms (Arrays, Hashing, Trees, Graphs, Dynamic Programming), LeetCode

• **Backend & Systems:** FastAPI, REST APIs, Microservices, Distributed Systems, ETL Pipelines, Kafka, PySpark

• **Databases, Cloud & Tools:** PostgreSQL, Neo4j, AWS (S3, EC2, EKS), GCP, Docker, Git

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

May 2025 - Present

Research Assistant - iSchool

Champaign, USA

• Owned end-to-end design and integration of cross-platform data pipeline for 100+ users, translating customer requirements into scalable ingestion workflows and third-party API connections

• Designed and optimized **PostgreSQL schema, indexing strategies, and query execution plans** for high-volume datasets, improving query performance by 38% under production workloads

• Built robust, production-ready **Python** pipeline with retrieval and context summarization, improving multi-turn response accuracy by **43%**

• Developed **backend workflows** for real-time, fault-tolerant processing of longitudinal health data with focus on reliability and scalability

Research Assistant - CHI AI in Infodemic Management

January 2025 - May 2025

• Designed and deployed highly **scalable NLP pipelines in Python** to process high-volume datasets, reducing processing latency by **41%**

• Built distributed data ingestion pipelines using **Kafka** and **Neo4j** Streams for real-time, high-throughput processing and pattern detection

• Designed and developed production-grade REST and GraphQL APIs using FastAPI, implementing validation, monitoring, and automated deployment workflows for scalable integration across distributed systems

• Enabled large-scale data processing across social media streams using **distributed system architecture** principles

Business Intelligence Group

August 2025 - December 2025

Technical Consultant

Champaign, USA

• Built and deployed scalable microservices-based RAG platform integrating OpenAI and Anthropic APIs, using FastAPI, PostgreSQL, and vector embeddings to serve production applications

• Designed fault-tolerant ETL pipelines and automated workflows using Python, TypeScript, and Node.js to ingest, transform, and index large document datasets for low-latency retrieval

• Improved system performance by **64%** through optimized indexing strategies and pipeline efficiency improvements in production environments

• Developed backend services enabling real-time, high-performance querying of unstructured data across distributed system architectures

Swift Mobil Software Solutions Provider

July 2023 - October 2023

Data Analyst

Mumbai, IN

• Built interactive **Power BI** dashboards for **logistics** and **mobility KPIs**, reducing reporting time by **40%** and improving visibility into operational performance across transportation services and decision-making insights

• Processed and optimized large-scale operational datasets using **Python** and **PySpark** to identify performance issues in distributed systems

• Developed **SQL** and **graph queries** to map dependencies, analyze operations, detect data quality issues, speeding root-cause analysis by **26%**

Pscope Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

January 2023 - June 2023

Data Analyst

Mumbai, IN

• Developed and maintained **20+ Power BI** dashboards across Sales, Finance, and Operations for enterprise clients, leveraging **SQL** for data extraction and **DAX** for advanced calculations, enabling KPI tracking and data-driven decision-making

• Automated recurring **Excel**-based reporting workflows using **VBA**, implementing data validation, transformation, and scheduling logic, reducing report preparation time by **42%** and improving data consistency across weekly reporting cycles

Stu/Dio at Illinois

August 2025 - Present

Project Manager

Champaign, USA

• Led cross-functional team of **6** engineers and designers to deliver product updates for DeepCover game, leveraging user feedback, telemetry data, and performance insights to drive data-driven feature prioritization and improvements

• Tracked **sprint** progress, delivery metrics, and **QA issues** through **JIRA**-based workflows, managing backlog grooming, sprint planning, and issue resolution to improve cross-team visibility and ensure on-time milestone delivery

PROJECTS

Scalable ML System for Customer Risk Prediction

March 2025

UIUC Hackathon

• Built an **end-to-end machine learning system** using Python, Pandas, and LightGBM to forecast customer spending and assess credit risk from large-scale **time-series** transaction data, including data preprocessing, feature engineering, model training, and evaluation

• Designed and implemented **scalable ETL and feature engineering pipelines**, capturing behavioral trends and temporal patterns such as rolling averages and spending frequency to improve model performance

• Developed a **decision framework for credit line adjustments**, incorporating model outputs and risk thresholds to improve prediction precision by 20% and enable risk-aware classification of customers